



Mental math

EVERYDAY PROBLEMS CAN BE SIMPLIFIED SO THAT THEY CAN BE EASILY DONE WITHOUT USING A CALCULATOR.

SEE ALSO

◀ 18–21 Multiplication

◀ 22–25 Division

Using
a calculator

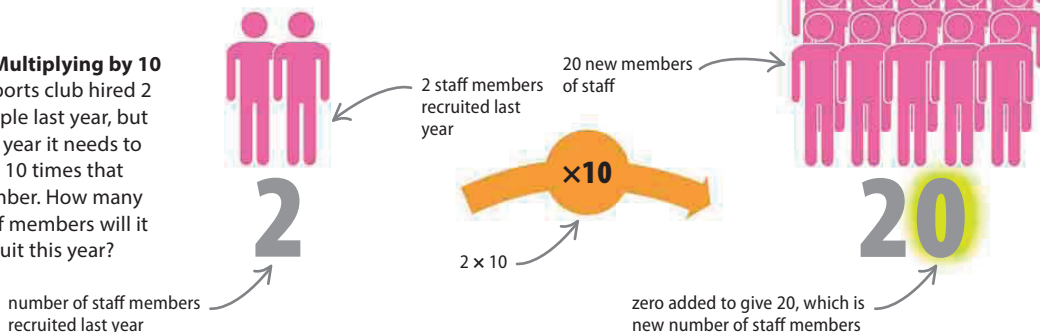
72–73 ▶

MULTIPLICATION

Multiplying by some numbers can be easy. For example, to multiply by 10 either add a 0 or move the decimal point one place to the right. To multiply by 20, multiply by 10 and then double the answer.

▶ Multiplying by 10

A sports club hired 2 people last year, but this year it needs to hire 10 times that number. How many staff members will it recruit this year?

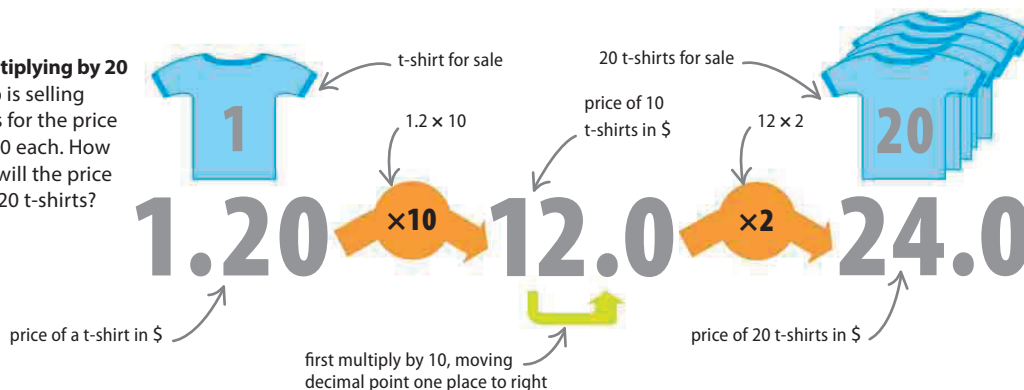


◀ Finding the answer

To multiply 2 by 10 add a 0 to the 2. Multiplying 2 people by 10 results in an answer of 20.

▶ Multiplying by 20

A shop is selling t-shirts for the price of \$1.20 each. How much will the price be for 20 t-shirts?

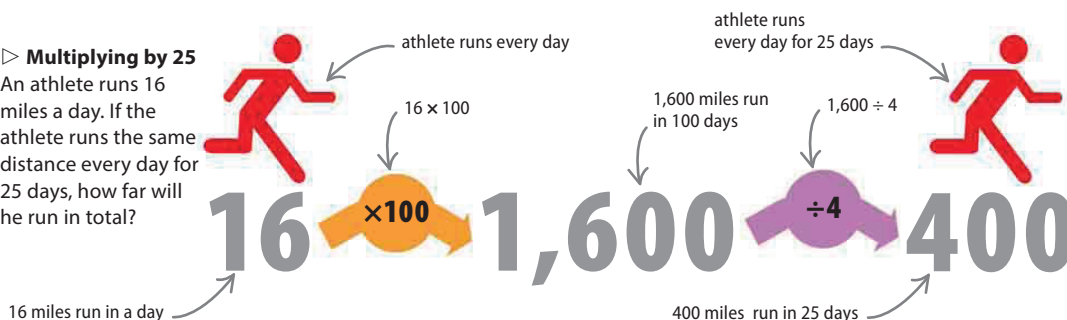


◀ Finding the answer

First multiply the price by 10, here by moving the decimal point one place to the right, and then double that to give the final price of \$24.

▶ Multiplying by 25

An athlete runs 16 miles a day. If the athlete runs the same distance every day for 25 days, how far will he run in total?



◀ Finding the answer

First multiply the 16 miles for one day by 100, to give 1,600 miles for 100 days, then divide by 4 to give the answer over 25 days.